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	Document Title:	COMPLETED RESEARCH	Revision No.	00
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(1) Research Program/Project/Study Title:

SINDA: THE MOTHER NATURE VENGEANCE ON ENVIRONMENTAL EXPLOITATION

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Program or Project has component (if no proceed to 2)? ☐ Yes ☐ No

Component Title:	
Component Leader:	
Academic Rank:	

(2) Category (please check)

- ☒ Social Science/Education /Humanities & other related fields
☐ Natural/BiologicalSciences
☐ Food Research/
☐ Developmental/ Computer/Engineering/ Architecture
☐ Extension
☐ Poster

(3) Research Center

[Check the concerned center]

- ☒ SSITRDC
 Social Science and Industrial
 Technology Research
 Development Center

☐ LRDC
 Livestock Research Development
 Center

☐ FFRDC
 Fisheries and Food Research
 Development Center

☐ CSRDC
 Crop Science Research
 Development Center

(4) Site of implementation

Municipality/City:	Tapaz
Province:	Capiz
Region:	VI

(5) Classification

Research:

Development:

☒ Basic

☐ Pilot Testing

☐ Applied

☐ Tech. Promotion/Commercialization

(6) Mode of Implementation

- ☒ Single Authorship/Proponent
☐ Collaborative Research (within campus)
☐ Collaborative Research (intercampus)
☐ Collaborative Research (external agency)

(7) Sector/Commodity

(8) Discipline/Field of Specialization

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(9A) Abstract (This has a maximum of 250 words. It contains 1-2 sentences of rationale, followed by objectives, brief methodology, major findings, and implications of impact of the study.)

(9B) Keywords (Write 3-6 words you used in the study, preferably not found in the title because words in the title are already given keywords. This would also include process, or methodology employed.)

Abstract

Mother Earth offers us everything. Humans have spent their entire lives altering ecological communities and ecosystems by taking advantage of what the nature offers. The exploitation of natural resources is the excessive human abuse of resources that the planet seems exhausted. Thus, this study explored on Sinda: The Mother Nature Vengeance on Environmental Exploitation at Tapaz, Capiz Philippines. Using the qualitative research design, two (3) informants from barangay Daan Banwa, Sta. Ana and Candelaria, Tapaz, Capiz were purposively chosen. Fieldwork, observations, informal and key informant interviews, and documentary and photographic analysis were the methods used. Verbatim data transcripts were analyzed using the general inductive approach (Thomas, 2006) and in vivo coding technique. The patterns of sinda vary from the origin and belief of the respondents in this local communities. In terms of dynamics, Sinda was known as a vengeance of mother earth in exploiting nature.

Keywords: Mother Earth, tradition, superstition, deforestation

(10) Introduction (This includes the rationale, background of the study, and objectives which are not divided by subheadings. Incorporate at least three (3) reviews).

These days environmental issues are among the most reported ones in the world. The dangerous effects of the environmental problems and destruction of nature are as old as the history of humanity. In former times the environmental problems were felt only at a local level with the destruction of forests to facilitate hunting places and clear lands for farming areas. Nowadays, when environment problems come into question, many people prefer using the term environmental disaster in place of the term environmental problems. This term, environmental disaster, may be remarkable enough to discern the severity of the problem. Creating awareness is an important issue since many people are not aware of the fact that the nature is destroyed by humans, and they neglect that the harm to nature causes the harm to humanity concurrently since there has always been an indissoluble bond between ecosystem and humans. Humans cannot be dissociated from the natural world since the destruction of nature by human is not an instantaneous reality.

As stewards of God's creation, it is believe that humans have a responsibility towards the environment, a duty to do what they can to ensure they are environmentally responsible. Each individual is responsible for their contribution to the environment and therefore must ensure they act to protect it. However, it is a belief that mother earth can be a wicked woman. When challenge and exploit it is believe that nature and the natural world is an embodiment of divinity, sacredness or spiritual power considering the environment to be imbued with spirits and other sacred entities.

Persons who are harming mother nature are said to suffer "*sinda*", a Hiligaynon word which means "hit by the spell of environmental spirits". *Sinda* comes to the person through the *bululakaw*, a malevolent god in the form of a bird with a flaming tail. The person who is *sininda* will suffer from stomachache, pain, pang, or stwinge where the patient developed severe pains and distension without any reason. According to the local folks, the illness can be caused by *sa-ub*, a Hiligaynon word means "possession" by *tamawo*, a local dialect which is equivalent to "spirits residing in trees and springs". In our *kalibutan*, the Ilonggo terms which means 'universe' in English word, it consists of three parts: the *udtohan* 'upper world', inhabited by God and his virtuous angels; the *katung-anan* 'middle world', inhabited by *tamawo*, *tubignon*, and *tabuknon* 'spirits of trees, rivers, and seas', who were once Lucifer and his followers and can assume the form of a *kataw* 'mermaid' or a *siokoy* 'merman'; and the *idadalman* or *idadalman* 'underworld', inhabited by the *engkanto* or *tamawo* 'evil spirits'. God and his angels keep themselves remote from the people. It is the spirits of the underworld who actively engage in human affairs. The *tamawo* can be either friendly or evil. They live in resplendent palaces that look like mere boulders to the human eye in forests and wilderness. When a person harm the environment like cutting down tress or destroy their homes, they entice the person by inflicting *Sinda*. Furthermore, according to the local folks, there were *engkantos* which are believed to reside in places called *palhi* or *mari-it* such as cliffs, bamboo groves, boulders, earth mounds, and large trees like the acacia and balet.

Sinda takes a holistic view of the individual, including environmental factors that affect a person's physical, mental, emotional, and spiritual well-being. It was first documented in the 16th century at the start of Spanish colonization, so it's hard to tell how early it began.

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In Tapaz, Capiz Philippines, the Sinda is a culture and communicated with spirits that were thought to be associated with nature's vengeance. The implication that there exists something such as human nature suggests that there is a particular stance with relation to the things or rather what a human being actually is.

Considering the Platonic Theory, human beings are seen as rational and social creatures. In this theory, Plato attempts to identify the nature of human beings with reason and the souls of humans and not just their bodies. In indentifying humans, the theory looks at the souls that humans have and it is this that dictates the role that they ought to be playing in the environment he is living in.

Sinda is anchored to the Adaptation theory, also known as survival theory or survival of the fittest, an organism's ability to adapt to changes in its environment and adjust accordingly over time. As Sinda involves pain in a local area, esp. a spot on the back which may move to another area; or a migraine, a kind of recurrent headache that affects the head.

According to Stewart Brand(2009), what we call and what we call human are inseparable. We live one life. The common folk diagnosis is that patients become sick due to supernatural illness-causers such as a duwende (dwarf), a nuno, a lamang-lupa a creature from the earth or underground or under the soil, a tikbalang, or a kapre.

Along with other cultural traditions, Sinda began to fade. It is the aspiration of the researcher to narrate the patterns and issues on sinda with the purpose that this study will add on the body of knowledge concerning the limited literature and shed the light to showcase the rich culture of Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines.

The study generally aims to document and analyze the Sinda: Mother Nature Vengeance on Environmental Exploitation at Tapaz, Capiz Philippines.

Specifically, the study aims to answer the following questions:

1. What are the underlying issues on the Sinda as the Mother Nature Vengeance on Environmental Exploitation at Tapaz, Capiz Philippines?
2. What are the different superstitious beliefs of Sinda at Tapaz, Capiz Philippines?
3. What are the superstitious beliefs about Sinda that are still being used today?

(11) Materials and Methods or Methodology (This includes the materials, methods,duration & location of the study. Materials and Methods are headings used in Natural Science researches and methodology is Social Sciences. Presentation of materials may not necessarily be in separate heading but may be incorporated in the specific methods used. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

Research Design

The study used the qualitative research design. Qualitative research stress the socially constructed nature of reality. This design is naturalistic, emergent, and purpose focuses on real-world situations as they unfold naturally. There is acceptance of adapting inquiry as understanding deepens. Cases for study such as individuals or communities are selected because they are information rich and illuminative (Denzin & Lincoln, 2011, Berg, 2012 as cited in the study of Biclár 2022).

Participants

Purposive sampling was used to identify the two (3) key informants from barangay Daan Banwa, Sta. Ana and Candelaria, Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. The researcher has saturated within the community to those who have knowledge about the Sinda and fortunately, participants in coordination with barangay officials in the respective barangays willingly agreed. The local community of these three barangays were identified as participants of this study.

Locale of Study

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Statements	Code	Category	Theme
1. Cutting trees of the forest will harm my life	Deforestation	Bad action	Issues
2. Kaingin system will threaten life and property of the people	Deforestation	Bad action	Issues
3. Dumping wastes in the forest will harm Mother Nature and the person doing it	Poor waste management	Bad action	Issues
4. Playing in the forest and harming existing fauna will cause extinction	Negligence	Irresponsibility	Superstitions
5. Formal greetings must be done as a sign of respect for nature	Negligence	Irresponsibility	Superstitions
6. Imaginary people living in the forest will inflict disease on the disturber	Revenge	Vengefulness	Superstitions
7. Offerings must be given to the imaginary people living in the forest	Offerings	Thoughtful practice	Superstitions
8. Getting of fever after playing in the forest	Secondary sicknesses	After effects	Superstitions
9. Getting stomach upset after eating or touching fauna found in the forest	Secondary sicknesses	After effects	Superstitions

Discussions

The first primary organizing theme, “Issues” was linked into the category “Bad Action” which falls into the codes: 1) Cutting trees of the forest will harm my life 2) Kaingin system will threaten life and property of the people, and 3) Dumping wastes in the forest will harm Mother Nature and the person doing it. The secondary organizing theme, namely “Superstitious” was associated with the category “Irresponsibility” by which falls into the code of 1) Playing in the forest and harming existing fauna will cause extinction, 2) Formal greetings must be done as a sign of respect for nature, and 3) Imaginary people living in the forest will inflict disease on the disturber. The third organizing theme also linked with “Superstitions” were connected to the category of thoughtful practice and aftereffects which explain the following codes 1) Offerings must be given to the imaginary people living in the forest 2) Getting of fever after playing in the forest, and 3) Getting stomach upset after eating or touching fauna found in the forest.

For the first primary theme, different views arose from the participants’ answers regarding the Issues of Sinda 1) “Cutting trees of the forest will harm my life,” 2) “Kaingin system will threaten life and property of the people,” and 3) “Dumping wastes in the forest will harm Mother Nature and the person doing it.

The second theme and third theme which fall on “Superstitions” the responses of the participants shows that in Sinda 1) Playing in the forest and harming existing fauna will cause extinction 2) Formal greetings must be done as a sign of respect for nature 3) Imaginary people living in the forest will inflict disease on the disturber 4) Offerings must be given to the imaginary people living in the forest 5) Getting of fever after playing in the forest, and 6) Getting stomach upset after eating or touching fauna found in the forest.

(13) Conclusions and Recommendations (This part shall be written in narrative form and arranged based on the objectives and findings. Conclusions are general statements answering the objectives. Recommendations are based on the conclusions. They may be split or combined based on their length, which means, conclusions and recommendations may be split under separate headings if they are long. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.).

The patterns of sinda vary from the origin and belief of the respondents in three local communities. In terms of dynamics, Sinda was known as a vengeance of mother earth in exploiting nature as this was known to believers until this era where illness is experience in the locality.

Through the obtained data that tackled the lived experiences of the participants, this study was able to contribute the first qualitative data on the superstitious beliefs of folks Tapaz, Capiz, Philippines. Therefore, this study has paved an avenue for a better understanding regarding such while contributing a solution to the scarcity of literature depicting its culture. This problem greatly contributes to the misconceptions of people towards Sinda.

This study aids participants in learning about Sinda as superstitious belief and better understanding patients who experience the illness and undergone the abrupt treatment approach. This will help in guiding a patient's desire of blending illness with proper approach that can help bridge communication gaps by providing opportunities for open-minded local people, establishing trust, and safeguarding mother nature, eventually leading to better a safe and green environment.

For future research, this study recommends utilizing a larger sample size for data saturation, yielding more responses and newly gathered data about the topic at hand.

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(14) Output (Indicate the specific products, processes or services which the project has produced; quantify when possible.)

(15) Technology Transfer Activity Conducted (Indicate the specific products, activity design, processes or services transferred as extension activities)

(16) Economic Analysis (This should present the direct cost of project implementation, expenses in the production of technology, revenues generated from technology produced, return on investment (ROI) and payback period.

(17) Acknowledgments (Include only important persons and institutions with involvement in funding and conduct of the research. Justify paragraphs with main headings in caps.)

(18) References (It should include only works mentioned in the text and should be arranged alphabetically. Citations shall not be less than 13 entries. This must follow the APA latest edition format, in hanging indentation with 12-point space in between.)

Manuell, M. E., & Cukor, J. (2011). Mother Nature versus human nature: public compliance with evacuation and quarantine. *Disasters*, 35(2), 417-442.

Roach, C. M. (2003). *Mother/nature: Popular culture and environmental ethics*. Indiana University Press.

Berman, T. (2006). The rape of mother nature. *Ecolinguistics Reader: Language, Ecology and Environment*, 258.

Jelinski, D. E. (2005). There is no Mother Nature: There is no Balance of Nature: Culture, ecology and conservation. *Human Ecology*, 33(2), 271-288.

Swanson, L. J. (2015). A feminist ethic that binds us to mother earth. *Ethics & the Environment*, 20(2), 83-103.

(20) Capsule Curriculum Vitae (One-page brief C.V. only)

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